FacelessStack

The Faceless Shorts Starter Kit

The exact workflow, prompts, voice settings and caption rules I use to make a faceless Short in about an hour, without a camera, a face or editing experience.

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Some tools in this kit are linked with affiliate links. If you subscribe through them I may earn a commission at no extra cost to you. Free alternatives are listed for every paid tool. Settings are starting points from my own videos, not guarantees. Tool menus and prices change, so check before you buy.

01 The 1-hour workflow

One idea, one Short, about 20–25 seconds. Follow the steps in order and don't skip the script rules. They're what make people keep watching.

1 **Pick one surprising idea** — 5 min

Not a list. A single "How / Why / What if" question with a twist answer. Check the fact in a reliable source and save the link.

2 **Write the script (≈60 words)** — 10 min

Second 1 is already the action plus a shock line. Tell it as a mini story where the character does the wrong thing and it backfires. The fact lands as the twist. End with a funny line or one that loops back to the start. No "like and subscribe".

3 **Lock the look** — 5 min

Write one CHARACTER block and one STYLE block (section 02). Generate the first image, check it, then attach it as the reference image for every other shot.

4 **Generate 6–8 images** — 10 min

Same CHARACTER + STYLE blocks word for word. Only the SCENE line changes. 9:16 vertical, leave the top fifth simple for captions.

5 **Animate the best 4–5** — 10 min

Image-to-video, 8 s, sound off. Prompt: "Animate this exact image. <motion>. Keep the character, colors and style exactly as in the image. No text." Reuse each clip for 2–3 shots at different in-points or zooms.

6 **Voice-over** — 5 min

One take with delivery tags (section 03). Listen once at 1× before you edit.

7 **Edit + captions** — 12 min

A cut every 1.5–2 s (11–14 shots). Word-by-word captions with the key word highlighted. Add sound effects on impacts. Rules in section 04.

8 **Check + publish** — 3 min

18–26 s long, no black frames, captions never cover the face, audio not clipping. Title = question + one emoji. Answer the platform's AI-content question truthfully.

The rule that matters most: keep your STYLE block identical in every prompt. Most "AI slop" comes from changing the style a little in every shot.

02 15 visual prompt templates

Every image prompt is built from three blocks. Copy the blocks word for word and only rewrite the SCENE line. That's how one character survives 8 different shots.

```
[CHARACTER block]  →  who, exactly the same every time
[STYLE block]      →  the look, exactly the same every time
SCENE: one or two sentences: action, expression, camera angle, one thing in mid-air.
```

I use Higgsfield's image models for stills (vertical 9:16, 2K) and its video models for image-to-video. The templates are plain English, so they also work in most other image generators.

CHARACTER Lock blocks

1 Mascot character (attach your reference image)

```
Use the attached reference image for the character [NAME]: keep the exact [body shape], [skin/colour], [eyes], [eyebrows], [hair], [top] and [bottoms]. Vertical 9:16, keep the top fifth simple for captions. No text, no letters, no watermark, no logo.
```

2 Faceless human: no identity to keep consistent

```
A person seen only from behind or from the shoulders down, hands visible, wearing a plain [colour] hoodie, face never shown. Vertical 9:16, top fifth simple for captions. No text, no watermark.
```

3 Talking object: the product or thing is the star

```
A [object] with small expressive cartoon eyes and a tiny mouth, otherwise realistic materials and proportions, the same eyes and colours in every shot. Vertical 9:16, top fifth simple for captions. No text, no logo.
```

02 Style blocks

Choose one per video. Paste it after your CHARACTER block.

4 Cinematic 3D feature film: my main look

```
High-end stylized 3D animated feature-film still. Rich saturated colors and high contrast. Dramatic cinematic lighting: strong cold electric-blue rim light from behind and a warm orange key light on the face. Deep moody environment colors so the character pops. Wide-angle lens, close so the character fills about half the frame. Small particles caught mid-air in the light, glossy highlights, shallow depth of field.
```

5 X-ray cutaway: the "how it works" shot, once per video

```
Split-view educational cutaway in a clean 3D medical-animation look. Above the dividing line the character looks normal; below it the body is semi-transparent like an x-ray, revealing the relevant organ glowing hot red or orange, with neon cyan lines showing what is happening inside. Dark navy background, neon cyan and red highlights, high contrast, close framing.
```

6 Paper-cutout storybook: great for history

```
Layered paper-cutout pop-up storybook diorama, visible paper edges and soft shadows between layers, warm tungsten light, faceless paper figures, textured card stock, shallow depth of field.
```

7 Claymation: great for gross/funny body topics

```
Squishy claymation stop-motion look, visible fingerprints and tool marks in the clay, soft studio lighting, saturated candy colors, miniature handmade set.
```

8 Macro nature: animals and science

```
Hyper-detailed macro nature photography look, extreme close-up, dewdrops, razor-thin focus plane, dark natural background, rim-lit edges, frozen slow-motion moment.
```

9 Epic space: "what if" topics

```
Epic cinematic space CGI, enormous sense of scale, deep black space with glowing atmosphere edges, volumetric light rays, tiny details for scale, IMAX-style composition.
```

02 More styles & motion prompts

10 Cinematic product macro: for product and brand videos

```
Premium commercial product shot, the [product] on a dark reflective surface, single hard key light raking across the texture, soft fill, floating dust particles in the beam, macro lens, deep shadows, luxury ad look. No text, no logo.
```

11 Bold 2D cartoon: tricks and life hacks

```
Bright flat 2D cartoon with thick black outlines, simple shapes, punchy primary colors, comic-book action lines, clean white or single-color background.
```

12 Clean desk B-roll: for tutorials and talking-over-screen videos

```
Top-down view of a minimal dark desk with a laptop showing a blurred editing interface, a coffee mug, soft window light from the left, muted dark tones with one lime-green accent object. No readable text on screen.
```

MOTION Image-to-video prompts

Always start with: "Animate this exact image." and end with: "Keep the character, colors and style exactly as in the image. No text."

13 Impact / reveal

```
Animate this exact image. Fast push-in toward the character's face, particles burst outward on impact, a tiny camera shake at the peak. Keep the character, colors and style exactly as in the image. No text.
```

14 Calm explainer (good for x-ray shots)

```
Animate this exact image. Slow orbit around the subject, the glowing lines pulse gently and travel along their paths, everything else stays still. Keep the character, colors and style exactly as in the image. No text.
```

15 Reaction loop (ending shot)

```
Animate this exact image. The character blinks, does a small double-take and freezes in a funny expression; the camera holds still. Keep the character, colors and style exactly as in the image. No text.
```

03 Voice presets & delivery tags

A flat AI voice kills retention faster than bad visuals. Start from these presets, then change one slider at a time.

Classic sliders (ElevenLabs multilingual models)

Preset	Stability	Similarity	Style	Use for
Calm documentary	60%	80%	10%	Explainers, tutorials, x-ray shots
Energetic hook	35%	75%	40%	The first 3 seconds, reveals
Storyteller	45%	80%	30%	Mini-story Shorts
Deadpan narrator	70%	85%	0%	Comedy and twist endings

Lower stability = more emotion but more random takes. Higher style = more drama but slower to generate and occasionally odd. These are my starting points, not official recommendations.

Eleven v3: steer it with tags instead of sliders

v3 reads the emotion from bracketed tags inside the script. Put a tag right before the words it should affect:

```
[urgent] So you've fallen through the ice.
[deadpan] Here's the thing. The cold won't get you first.
[whispers] Panic will.
[sighs] And you're already doing it.
```

- Tags that work well for Shorts: **[urgent] [deadpan] [whispers] [sighs] [laughs] [excited] [curious]**.
- Use 1 tag per sentence at most. More than that sounds theatrical.
- Short sentences. A full stop = a breath. Write numbers as words ("eight seconds").
- Generate one take, listen once, and regenerate only the line that's wrong.

> **Voice cloning rule:** only clone your own voice, or one you have written permission to use. Never a celebrity or a real person without consent.

Free option: ElevenLabs' free tier (limited characters, attribution required on free plans; check current terms) or your operating system's built-in text-to-speech for drafts.

04 Caption & editing rules

Most Shorts are watched with the sound low or off. Captions aren't decoration. They carry the story.

Captions

- **1–3 words on screen at a time**, timed to the voice word by word.
- **Highlight one keyword per line** in a single accent colour (yellow or lime). Same colour all video.
- **Bold sans-serif, white with a dark outline or shadow.** Readable on any background.
- **Place them in the top fifth or centre-low**, never over the face and never in the bottom 15% (the platform UI covers it).
- **A small pop-in animation** on each word. Skip spinning, bouncing or rainbow effects.
- Always proofread names and numbers. Auto-captions mishear them.

Editing

- **A cut every 1.5–2 seconds**: 11–14 shots in a 22-second Short.
- **Reuse clips**: one 8-s clip can give 2–3 shots at different in-points or zoom levels.
- **Slow zoom on stills** (100→110%) so nothing is ever frozen.
- **A sound effect on every impact**: whoosh on cuts, boom on reveals. Use royalty-free SFX only.
- **Music at about −20 dB** under the voice, or none at all.
- **The loop:** make the last frame flow into the first so replays feel natural.

Tools

Need	Paid (what I use or recommend)	Free option
Animated word-by-word captions	Submagic	CapCut auto-captions
Cutting long videos into Shorts	Submagic or OpusClip	Manual cuts in CapCut / DaVinci Resolve
Full edit	n/a	CapCut, DaVinci Resolve

Retention check before publishing: watch it muted. If you can't follow the story from captions and visuals alone, fix the captions.

05 Real cost sheet

What one 22-second Short costs me in Higgsfield credits. The credit costs are what I'm charged per generation with the settings shown. Your plan decides what a credit is worth in dollars.

Item	Setting	Credits each	Qty	Credits
Still images	Image model, 9:16, 2K, 1 image	2	8	16
Animated clips	Image-to-video, 8 s, 720p, sound off	8	5	40
Voice-over	Eleven v3, one take	≈1.4	1	≈1.4
Re-dos (1 bad shot)	n/a	2–8	1	≈4
Typical total per Short				**≈60 (cap: 65)**

Credit prices and model costs change. Check the cost shown next to the Generate button before each run.

Turn it into dollars (fill in)

Line	Your number
Monthly plan price ($)	_____
Credits included per month	_____
$ per credit = price ÷ credits	_____
$ per Short = 60 × $ per credit	_____
Shorts per month = credits ÷ 60	_____
Other tools (captions, voice, music) $/month	_____

How to spend fewer credits

- Use stills with a slow zoom for x-ray and diagram shots. Only animate the action shots.
- Get one perfect reference image first. It prevents most re-dos.
- One voice take, then fix only the wrong line.
- Reuse each clip 2–3 times at different in-points.

06 30-day content calendar

One Short a day, rotating 5 formats so you learn which one your audience wants. The editable version is **content-calendar.csv**; import it into Google Sheets or Notion.

Day	Format	What to make
Mon	How / Why	One surprising fact, told as a mini story
Tue	What if	A big hypothetical with an epic visual
Wed	X-ray	What happens inside the body or a machine
Thu	Myth vs fact	A common belief, then the twist
Fri	Remix the winner	Same topic or style as your best video this week, new angle
Sat	Style test	A new visual style from section 02
Sun	Review	Log views + average % viewed, choose next week's topics

Weekly review (Sunday, 20 minutes)

- Log every video's **views at 3 days** and **average % viewed**.
- **Keep** the top 2 formats and double them next week.
- **Drop** any format under 50% average viewed for 3 videos in a row.
- **Steal from yourself**: the hook of your best video becomes the template for next week's hooks.

Want the full breakdown of each Short I make? New teardowns, cheat sheets and free guides go up at **mussirimajid-rgb.github.io/facelessstack**.